Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A112B
Cultures II
Main – All Branches
Midterm Exam

2025-2026/Fall Semester
Date: 18 Nov. 2025
5:00 – 7:00

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 Hours**

INSTRUCTIONS

This Exam consists of TWO PARTS.

Part 1 contains 3 Short Answer Questions. You must choose TWO and fully answer them in PARAGRAPH FORMAT.

Part 2 contains 2 Essay Questions. You must choose ONE of them and fully answer it in ESSAY FORMAT.

Write the question number next to each answer.

Do not answer more questions than required.

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Part 1: Short Answer Questions
(10 points = 5 points for each answer)

Please choose TWO of the following questions and respond to them in paragraph format. Each answer should be approximately 80 words long, addressing all relevant aspects of the question with appropriate evidence from the course material. Ensure that each paragraph includes a clear topic sentence, supporting details, and a conclusion.

1. What are the common **features** or **characteristics** often found in **'literary classics'**?
2. What are the **different kinds** of **'disguise'** or **'concealment'** used in **Shakespeare's *Twelfth Night***?
3. Why isn't **Charlotte Brontë's name** on the **title page** of the first edition of ***Jane Eyre***?

Part 2: Essay Questions
(20 points)

Please choose ONE of the essay prompts below and write a comprehensive response in essay format. Your essay should be around 350 words, covering all relevant aspects of the question and backed by evidence from the course material. Make sure to structure your essay with an introduction, multiple body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

4. Examine the **plot structure** of **Shakespeare's *Twelfth Night***, and elaborate on its **key elements**.

   Use these questions to help structure your essay and ensure all required aspects are covered:

   a. **Exposition** and **Inciting Incident:** How does the exposition of *Twelfth Night* introduce the audience to the main characters, setting, and initial conflict, and what crucial information is established during this phase of the play? What is the inciting incident that sets the central romantic and mistaken identity conflicts in motion?

   b. **Rising Action:** What events in the rising action of *Twelfth Night* create complications, build suspense, and advance the central romantic and comedic plotlines, and how do these events lead to the eventual climax?

   c. **Climax:** Identify the climactic moment in *Twelfth Night* when the central conflict reaches its peak, and explain how this moment resolves or intensifies the romantic entanglements and cases of mistaken identity.

   d. **Falling Action:** How does the falling action of the play work to unravel the complications and misunderstandings that arose during the rising action, and what role does it play in preparing the audience for the resolution?

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e. **Resolution:** What is the ultimate outcome and resolution of the various romantic relationships and character arcs in *Twelfth Night*, and how does this resolution tie up the loose ends of the plot and provide a sense of closure to the audience?

5. ***Jane Eyre*** is often described as a **Bildungsroman**, or a **coming-of-age novel**. Begin by **defining** what a Bildungsroman is, including its **key features** and **characteristics**. Then, analyze how *Jane Eyre* fits this genre by tracing Jane's growth and development through her experiences at **Gateshead**, **Lowood**, **Thornfield**, **Moor House**, and **Ferndean**. Consider how important relationships in each stage of her life influence her identity and sense of self.

Use these questions to help structure your essay and ensure all required aspects are covered:

a. **Genre Definition:** What are the key features and characteristics of a Bildungsroman (coming-of-age novel)?

b. **Early Development (Gateshead & Lowood):** How do Jane's experiences at Gateshead and Lowood shape her initial sense of self, her moral compass, and her desire for independence?

c. **Maturation and Conflict (Thornfield):** How do the relationships at Thornfield, particularly with Mr. Rochester, drive Jane's emotional maturation and challenge her established identity and ethical principles?

d. **Testing and Self-Discovery (Moor House):** How does Jane's time at Moor House, and her relationship with the Rivers family, allow her to discover her lineage, test her spiritual values, and define her true sense of self-worth and purpose?

e. **Final Integration (Ferndean):** How does Jane's eventual return to Mr. Rochester at Ferndean complete her developmental journey, demonstrating a final, integrated identity that balances passion, independence, and social equality?

End of the Exam!

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